

# Support for Cirq MatrixGates of >2 qubits and ControlledGate

<https://github.com/quantumlib/qsim/issues/163>

ROW 74

# Support for Cirq MatrixGates of >2 qubits and ControlledGate #163

New issue



Closed



andrewyatesg opened on Aug 1, 2020

...

I noticed that the qsim Cirq interface doesn't support MatrixGates that act on more than two qubits - can we get support for this?

I also noticed that if I create a controlled gate via something like this:

```
ControlledGate(MyGate)(ctrl_qubit, *target_qubits)
```

then qsim fails. For example `ControlledGate(cirq.X)(qubits[0], qubits[1])` returns the error

```
ValueError: Operation doesn't satisfy the given 'keep' but can't be decomposed:
cirq.X(cirq.LineQubit(1)).controlled_by(cirq.LineQubit(0)).
```

(I know that in this situation, one should use `cirq.CX`.) Can we get support for arbitrary ControlledGates? And are there any workarounds for the above two issues? Thanks!



Assignees

No one assigned

Labels

No labels

Type

No type

Projects

No projects

Milestone

No milestone

Relationships

None yet

Development

No branches or pull requests

Notifications

Customize

Subscribe

You're not receiving notifications from this thread.

Participants

+1



95-martin-orion on Aug 3, 2020

Collaborator ...

Unfortunately, the two-qubit matrix gate limitation is based on a core assumption of qsim that *all* gates act on at most two qubits. In my understanding, extending this to 3-qubit gates might be possible, but it would involve compromises in performance on 1- and 2-qubit gates.

Aside from manually decomposing these gates into 1- and 2-qubit gates, I don't know of a good workaround for this - @sergeisakov might be able to explain further.

On a similar note, controlled gates on >2 qubits (including control qubits) are also out of scope for qsim. Controlled 1-qubit gates should be possible, but currently Cirq doesn't support removing `controlled_by` via gate decomposition. In theory we could handle this in qsim, but I think the correct solution would instead be to update the decomposition behavior in Cirq. This is an area of active discussion in the Cirq dev team - I encourage you to open an issue there.

Until that's resolved, the workaround for controlled 1-qubit gates would be to use builtin controlled gates where possible, and define any others as 2-qubit matrix gates. Larger controlled gates would have to fall back to manual decomposition.



we-taper on Aug 6, 2020

...

Hi @95-martin-orion, I wonder if it is possible to add subroutines specifically for multi-qubit controlled gates and also prevent compromises in performance on 1 and 2 qubit gates? There is a [very simple algorithm](#) that can simulate gates of very large controlled qubits with very small memory overhead. Is it possible to integrate this to qsim?



sergeisakov on Aug 6, 2020

Collaborator ...

There are plans to add support for multi-qubit gates in general and for multi-qubit controlled gates in particular. It will be added at some point later.



MichaelBroughton mentioned this on Aug 21, 2020

  **MichaelBroughton** mentioned this on Aug 21, 2020  
[Allow custom gate serialization tensorflow/quantum#354](#)

  **95-martin-orion** mentioned this on Aug 26, 2020  
[Attempt to decompose Cirq gates #183](#)



**we-taper** on Aug 31, 2020

Hi qsim developers, we are filling [this RFC](#) for an implementation of multi-controlled 1 qubit gates.  
Looking forwards to comments!



**sergeisakov** on Aug 31, 2020

Collaborator ...

Thank you for writing that. We are actually working on multi-qubit and multi-controlled gates. It is likely that multi-controlled gates will be implemented in a different way from as implemented in the QuEST simulator.



**MichaelBroughton** on Oct 22, 2020

Collaborator ...

[@sergeisakov](#) any updates on progress here ? This would definitely be a nice to have feature for TFQ.



**95-martin-orion** on Oct 22, 2020

Collaborator ...

PR [#216](#) allows the C++ layers of qsim to recognize (but not execute) multi-controlled gates. The effort to support execution of these gates, as well as translating them from Cirq, is ongoing.



**yiyou-chen** on Nov 3, 2020 · edited by yiyou-chen

Edits ...

Got this error when doing controlled-ry:  
ValueError: Operation doesn't satisfy the given `keep` but can't be decomposed:  
`cirq.ry(np.pi*0.8904292526573554).on(cirq.GridQubit(0, 1)).controlled_by(cirq.GridQubit(0, 0))`  
would be really helpful if it can do 2-qubit controlled gates like C-ry(theta) if not multi-controlled or multi-qubit gates.  
Thanks.



**95-martin-orion** on Nov 3, 2020

Collaborator ...

Thanks for highlighting this, @4Dmovie. Work on this issue has been focused on multi-controlled gates in order to provide a general solution to the problem, with Sergei's PR [#231](#) being the most recent change submitted. I'll follow up with the qsimcirq support shortly, and will update this issue when the feature is available.



1

  **95-martin-orion** mentioned this on Nov 3, 2020  
[Allow control passthrough from Cirq. #233](#)

  **95-martin-orion** mentioned this on Nov 3, 2020

 [Allow control passthrough from Cirq, #233](#)



**95-martin-orion** on Nov 3, 2020

Collaborator ...

With PR [#233](#), controlled gates requested in Cirq should now be able to take advantage of the support in qsim-core. In particular, @4Dmovie's example with controlled-ry should work at HEAD (but note that we haven't released this change, so you'll need to install directly from GitHub to pick it up).

Support for larger matrix gates is still in progress.



 1



**yiyou-chen** on Nov 4, 2020

...

With PR [#233](#), controlled gates requested in Cirq should now be able to take advantage of the support in qsim-core. In particular, @4Dmovie's example with controlled-ry should work at HEAD (but note that we haven't released this change, so you'll need to install directly from GitHub to pick it up).

Support for larger matrix gates is still in progress.

Works for C-Ry now. Thank you so much for your team's amazing work! I'll let you know if further functionalities are demanded.



**95-martin-orion** on Dec 3, 2020

Collaborator ...

qsimcirq v0.6.0 provides support for arbitrary gates of up to six qubits. This includes any gate that can decompose into the qsim gateset (defined in [gates\\_cirq](#)) as well as any gate that has a matrix definition.



 **95-martin-orion** closed this as [completed](#) on Dec 3, 2020

# Allow control passthrough from Cirq. #233

<> Code

Merged 95-martin-orion merged 3 commits into master from qsimcirq-control on Nov 3, 2020

Conversation 9 Commits 3 Checks 0 Files changed 4 +143 -18



95-martin-orion commented on Nov 3, 2020

Collaborator

This PR is part of issue #163.

With this change, the qsim-core support for controlled gates is made available to Cirq users. Any number of control qubits can be requested, but the gates being controlled must still be 1- or 2-qubit gates. Passthrough for larger gates will be supported in a future PR.



Allow control passthrough from Cirq.

adbdabad

95-martin-orion requested a review from MichaelBroughton 5 years ago

google-cla bot added the cla:yes label on Nov 3, 2020



MichaelBroughton reviewed on Nov 3, 2020

View reviewed changes

MichaelBroughton left a comment

Collaborator

Looks good, left a couple questions in certain spots.



pybind\_interface/pybind\_main.h

Comment on lines +118 to +119

```
118 + m.def("control_last_gate", &control_last_gate,  
119 + "Applies controls to the final gate of a circuit.");
```



MichaelBroughton on Nov 3, 2020

Collaborator

Do this mean if I add a cirq.H to some circuit and then call into this I add control qubits to it ?



95-martin-orion on Nov 3, 2020

Collaborator Author

Yes. This is used exclusively for constructing qsim methods from Python via qsim\_circuit.py - users aren't expected to call the methods in this file directly.



Reply...

Reviewers

MichaelBroughton



Assignees

No one assigned

Labels

cla:yes

Projects

None yet

Milestone

No milestone

Development

Successfully merging this pull request may close these issues.

None yet

Notifications

Customize

Subscribe

You're not receiving notifications from this thread.

3 participants

